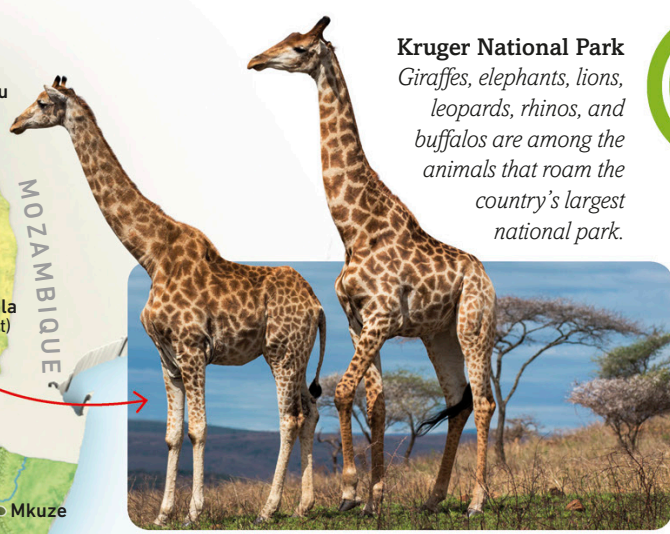




Johannesburg is the largest and most modern city.



Kruger National Park
Giraffes, elephants, lions, leopards, rhinos, and buffalos are among the animals that roam the country's largest national park.



King Protea
This tropical flowering plant native to South Africa is the national flower.



Xhosa people
The Xhosa people are the second-largest ethnic group. Historically linked with the Cape Town area, they live in all parts of South Africa.

Traditionally, married women wear an embroidered apron.



The Springboks
The South African rugby union team won the 2019 Rugby World Cup—their third win since 1995, when “one team, one country” symbolized national unity.



A boy from a Zulu cultural village dresses up for a show.

Zulu people
The largest ethnic group is the Zulu people. Traditionally, male warriors wore animal fur and feathers.

Geography: South Africa is dominated by a **high plateau**, fringed by **grasslands**, **deserts**, and narrow **coastal plains**.

History: The system of racial segregation known as **apartheid** ended in 1994, when **Nelson Mandela** became the first **black president**.

Culture: The **vibrant cultural mix** fuses many traditions in **literature** and the **music** of artists such as singer **Miriam Makeba**.

Natural wonders: The dramatic **Drakensberg Mountains** contrast with the lush **Garden Route coastline** west of Port Elizabeth.

Wildlife: South Africa is home to a rich variety of wildlife, including more than **200 mammal species** and **800 bird species**.